

RCM Specialist Badge Competency Matrix

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How the badge system works

A badge shows that a specialist can do one task type alone at production quality. It controls what work ClickUp routes to them and which level they can reach. There are 15 badges in three families. Every specialist in a full-cycle team is assessed against the same badges, whatever their previous title (coder, biller or negotiator).

Family	Badges	Classroom	What they mark
C (core)	C1 Attaching Docs, C2 Claim Follow-up, C3 Appeal, C4 Payment Posting, C5 Medical-Necessity Report	38 h	The routine work on every account. All five make an L1.
B (specialist)	B1 Coding, B2 IDR Process Workflow, B3 MVA and WComp Negotiation & Process, B4 Payer Strategy, B5 Payer Outreach	64 h	A specialty. B1 or B2 plus 2 of B3, B4, B5 make an L2.
A (advanced)	A1 Reporting and Analysis, A2 IDR Strategy, A3 Medical Terminology, A4 Billing Strategy, A5 Innovation	62 h	The team's experts. Needed for L3 and above.

Earning a badge follows four steps, the same for every badge:

1. Academy module. Classroom training run by the Academy (see Who runs the badge program), ending in a written or practical check.
2. Supervised production. A set number of real cases done under a badge-holder's review. The holder signs off each case in ClickUp.
3. Assessment. The Badge Panel scores a practical test plus a random sample of the supervised cases. Assessments run in the quarterly test windows: the last two weeks of March, June, September and December. Members enrol up to 4 weeks before.
4. Award. The Academy chair confirms the badge. Routing rights switch on the same day.

Testing out: a member who already does the work can sit a badge test in any window without the course. A pass is followed by 10 supervised cases before ClickUp routing switches on. New hires and people new to a task take the full course and supervised production.

Common rules:

- QA scores use the QA department's checklist for each badge.
- A critical error fails the case regardless of score: document on the wrong patient or account; missed deadline; PHI sent to the wrong party or an unapproved tool; unsupported code or level; appeal after the payer's limit; settlement or offer outside decision rights without approval; unbalanced posting batch.
- Assessors may not assess members of their own team.
- Thresholds below are starting values. The Academy Committee and the QA department review them after the first two quarters of data.

Who runs the badge program

The Training Academy Committee runs the program, chaired by a manager (preferably the Senior Manager). The QA department checks quality, and senior specialists assess. The Badges, Levels and Transition appendix sets the levels, test windows and badge-loss rules, and takes precedence where it differs from this matrix.

Role	Who	Responsibilities
Academy Committee chair	A manager, preferably the Senior Manager (L5)	Training calendar, badge records, award decisions, quarterly test windows, semiannual review, monthly team badge grid
Academy Committee	2–3 managers, 2 L4 Senior Specialists II, 2 L3 Senior Specialists I, 2 rotating team leads, 1 QA reviewer	Calibrates awards, placements and promotions
Badge Panel	A QA department reviewer plus 2 L4 Senior Specialists II or team leads from other teams	Scores assessments and samples of supervised cases

Role	Who	Responsibilities
QA department	The existing, separate QA department	QA checklists and scores, coding audit sample (5–10% of charts)
Pricing guide owner	A team manager, with the B4 Payer Strategy holders	Offer pricing guide and payer playbooks
Onshore–Offshore Liaison owner	A team manager	Ticket quality, coordination with the US desk; the bridge night rota reports here
Trainers	L4 Senior Specialists II and team leads	Teach Academy modules; teaching counts toward L4

Badges to levels

Level is set by the badges held; former title plays no part. L1 and L2 are automatic once the badges are held. L3, L4 and L5 need the badges and a leveling test.

Level	Badges required	Badges held	How you get it	Portfolio and role
L0 Junior RCM Specialist	None; newly recruited	0	On hire	Onboarding and C badge training
L1 RCM Specialist I	All 5 C badges	5	Automatic at the next quarterly window once the badges are held	Tier 3 (low-dollar, high-volume)
L2 RCM Specialist II	All 5 C + B1 or B2 + 2 of B3, B4, B5	8	Automatic at the next quarterly window once the badges are held	Tier 2 (standard NSA); full-cycle account owner
L3 Senior Specialist I	All 5 C + all 5 B + at least 1 of 5 A	11	The badges make you eligible for the L3 leveling test	Tier 1 (high-dollar, hardest payers); team expert, peer QA, mentor

Level	Badges required	Badges held	How you get it	Portfolio and role
L4 Senior Specialist II	All 5 C + all 5 B + at least 3 of 5 A	13	The badges make you eligible for the L4 leveling test	Tier 1 + one specialty-group lead; Badge Panel assessor, Academy trainer
L5 Principal (Leadership): Team Lead, Manager, Senior Manager	All 5 C + all 5 B + at least 4 of 5 A	14	The badges make you eligible for the L5 leveling test; a team lead or manager post is also required (internal posting)	A team or a portfolio

Leveling tests (L3, L4, L5): run in the quarterly test windows. Each is a case-based exam across the level's badges plus a review of the last 6 months: QA 95% or higher for L3, 97% or higher for L4 and L5, and zero missed deadlines. L5 adds a coaching assessment (team lead) or a leadership assessment (manager).

Annual top 10%: every December, members are ranked within their level on the year's KPIs. The top 10% automatically earn any badges of their current level they don't yet hold. An L2 in the top 10% moves up to L3 without the leveling test. Any L3 badges still missing are earned in the next 12 months while the level is kept.

New-hire path: L0 2-week onboarding, then C1 and C4 (months 1–2), C2 and C5 (months 3–4) and C3 (months 5–6). L1 follows automatically. Then B1 or B2 plus 2 of B3, B4, B5 lead to L2 automatically, typically 6–12 months later.

Leadership (L5): team leads and managers keep their badges and their QA reviews.

C badges (core)

The C badges cover the routine work on every account, so any L1 can work an account and cover for a colleague. All five are needed for L1. Classroom total: 38 hours.

C1. Attaching Docs

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Attaching and indexing EOBs, remits, medical records, payer letters and correspondence to the right patient hub and ClickUp task; requesting missing documents
Prerequisite	None (classroom 4 h)
Competency criteria	Every document indexed to the right patient, account and date of service; document type and date recorded on every upload; each document linked to its ClickUp task; missing documents requested within 2 business days and the request logged
Supervised production	50 accounts
Assessment	Index 20 mixed documents to the right accounts
QA to earn	98% or higher
QA to keep	97% or higher each quarter
Critical errors	Document attached to the wrong patient or account; records sent to the wrong party when requesting missing documents

C2. Claim Follow-up

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Confirming payer receipt, status follow-up, next-action dates, resubmission requests to Logistics
Prerequisite	C1 (classroom 8 h)
Competency criteria	Logs the mail date for every claim; confirms payer receipt within 21 days of mailing; every open claim has a next-action date; correct ClickUp status on every touch; resubmission requests to Logistics complete on the first pass

Element	Standard
Supervised production	40 claims across at least 5 payers
Assessment	Live status check of 10 claims with the assessor watching
QA to earn	95% or higher on the supervised cases
QA to keep	93% or higher each quarter
Critical errors	Claim left without a next-action date for more than 14 days; follow-up on the wrong patient or payer; missed timely-filing or resubmission deadline

C3. Appeal

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Code and money appeals under the NNSA process maps, including state-regulated plan claims; non-NSA denial resolution; the appeal letter library; payer appeal limits; applying the 12-month closing rule
Prerequisite	C2 (classroom 10 h)
Competency criteria	Selects the right appeal type; uses the approved letter from the library and cites the medical-necessity report; files within the payer's appeal limit; recommends closure at 12 months from DOS, with a final review for high-dollar claims
Supervised production	25 appeals covering at least 2 appeal types
Assessment	Writes 2 appeals from case files; scored by the Badge Panel
QA to earn	95% or higher
QA to keep	93% or higher each quarter
Critical errors	Appeal filed after the payer's limit; letter sent without supporting documents; claim closed without the required review

C4. Payment Posting

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Working the ERA exception queue, manual posting (about 10% of payments), posting IDR award payments, adjustments, refunds, claim closure
Prerequisite	None (classroom 8 h)

Element	Standard
Competency criteria	Posted amounts match the remittance to the cent; correct adjustment codes; IDR award payments matched to the determination within 2 business days of receipt; awards still unpaid 30 calendar days after the determination are flagged for follow-up
Supervised production	100 postings, including at least 20 manual and 10 IDR award payments
Assessment	Posting test of 30 items; the batch must balance exactly
QA to earn	99% or higher
QA to keep	98% or higher each quarter
Critical errors	Posting to the wrong account; unbalanced batch; claim closed with an open balance

C5. Medical-Necessity Report

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Generating the medical-necessity report with the approved LLM prompt library, checking and correcting it against the chart, filing it to the patient hub within 1 business day
Prerequisite	C1 (classroom 8 h)
Competency criteria	Uses only the current approved prompt version in the approved tool; every fact in the report is in the chart; covers presenting complaint, acuity, workup, treatment and disposition; filed within 1 business day of coding
Supervised production	30 reports
Assessment	Produces reports for 5 charts; the assessor checks each against the chart; zero factual errors allowed

Element	Standard
QA to earn	97% or higher, with zero factual errors
QA to keep	96% or higher each quarter
Critical errors	Any statement not supported by the chart; wrong patient; PHI entered into an unapproved tool

B badges (specialist)

The B badges are the specialties. B1 or B2 plus 2 of B3, B4 and B5 make an L2; all five are needed for L3. Every team keeps at least 2 holders of each. Classroom total: 64 hours.

B1. Coding

Element	Standard
Unlocks	ER professional and facility coding; E/M levels 99281–99285, procedures, ICD-10, modifiers, claim scrubbing, HCFA and UB-04 preparation for Logistics
Prerequisite	C5 (classroom 20 h)
Competency criteria	E/M level supported by the documentation; no unsupported level or code; correct modifiers; scrubbed claim passes edits on the first try; about 50 charts per coding day at full productivity
Supervised production	200 charts: every one of the first 50 reviewed, then a 20% sample
Assessment	Blind coding test of 50 charts; 95% or higher accuracy
QA to earn	95% or higher
QA to keep	95% or higher on the QA department's audit sample (5–10% of charts), reviewed monthly
Critical errors	Code or level not supported by the documentation; wrong patient or date of service

B2. IDR Process Workflow

Element	Standard
Unlocks	NSA eligibility at the initial payment or denial, the Open Negotiation notice (OMB form) and the 30-business-day period, IDR initiation, batching rules, entering disputes in the IDR Prep Studio, deadlines, logging determinations, award follow-up
Prerequisite	C2 (classroom 14 h)

Element	Standard
Competency criteria	Classifies NSA eligibility correctly (emergency service, out of network, plan type, date of initial payment or denial); Open Negotiation notice complete with the right claim items and QPA and sent with proof of delivery inside the 30-business-day window; IDR initiated on time; batching rules applied correctly (same payer, same or similar service codes, within the allowed window); every Studio entry passes validation on the first pass; determinations logged and award payments followed up
Supervised production	30 notices and 15 disputes prepared end to end
Assessment	Eligibility test of 20 scenarios (90% or higher) plus one practical initiation
QA to earn	98% or higher (deadline-critical work)
QA to keep	97% or higher each quarter
Critical errors	Notice or initiation outside its window; wrong items or missing QPA; dispute entered on the wrong account; settlement accepted beyond decision rights

B3. MVA and WComp Negotiation & Process

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Order of coverage (auto, PIP, MedPay, health, liability), workers' compensation claims process and state fee schedules, liens and attorney correspondence, records authorization, adjuster negotiation
Prerequisite	C2 and C3 (classroom 12 h)

Element	Standard
Competency criteria	Identifies the order of coverage before billing; bills workers' comp claims at the state fee schedule with the employer and claim number; files within carrier limits; documents every offer and counter-offer; settles within decision rights; releases records only with valid authorization
Supervised production	15 settlements, at least 5 of them workers' comp
Assessment	Negotiation role-play with the assessor acting as the adjuster; review of 3 closed case files
QA to earn	95% or higher
QA to keep	93% or higher each quarter
Critical errors	Settlement outside decision rights without approval; records released without authorization; workers' comp claim billed to the wrong coverage

B4. Payer Strategy

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Owning the playbook for 1-2 payers: QPA patterns, negotiation behavior, outcome trends, recommended offer ranges, escalation contacts; presenting monthly to the specialty group; feeding the pricing guide
Prerequisite	B2 (classroom 10 h)
Competency criteria	Playbook updated at least monthly; every recommendation backed by outcome data; measurable change in Net Recovery on the payer within 2 quarters
Supervised production	Co-own one payer playbook with an L4 Senior Specialist II for 1 quarter
Assessment	Presents the playbook to the Badge Panel and defends its recommendations

Element	Standard
QA to earn	90% or higher on the panel's playbook scorecard
QA to keep	90% or higher on the quarterly playbook review; no section older than 45 days
Critical errors	Recommendation contradicting the outcome data; playbook shared outside the team

B5. Payer Outreach

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Payer calls, payer portals, provider-relations contacts, call scripts, reference numbers, escalation paths
Prerequisite	C2 (classroom 8 h)
Competency criteria	Follows the payer call script; verifies the caller and claim details before sharing PHI; records the reference number, contact name and outcome in ClickUp on every contact; escalates through the right path when a payer misses its own deadline; keeps the payer contact list current
Supervised production	40 outreach contacts across at least 5 payers, including 10 recorded calls
Assessment	Review of 3 recorded calls plus one portal task
QA to earn	95% or higher
QA to keep	93% or higher each quarter
Critical errors	Wrong patient or payer on a call; PHI shared with an unverified party

A badges (advanced)

The A badges mark the team's experts. They carry stricter reviews because errors here cost the most. L3 needs at least 1, L4 at least 3 and L5 at least 4. Classroom total: 62 hours.

A1. Reporting and Analysis

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Reports and dashboards from ClickUp and eCW exports, KPI definitions, data checks, monthly trend analysis for a team or payer portfolio
Prerequisite	L2 (classroom 12 h)
Competency criteria	Uses the agreed KPI definitions; reconciles totals to the source export before publishing; states data gaps and assumptions; every analysis ends with a clear recommendation; monthly reports delivered on time
Supervised production	3 monthly analyses reviewed
Assessment	Analysis case from a raw export, presented to the Badge Panel
QA to earn	90% or higher on the panel's scorecard
QA to keep	90% or higher on the quarterly scorecard review
Critical errors	Report published with numbers that don't reconcile to the source; PHI in a report sent to the wrong party or an unapproved tool

A2. IDR Strategy

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Offer setting with the pricing guide and outcome data, IDR entity selection and objections, packet writing (QPA and additional factors), batching strategy, outcome review
Prerequisite	B2 (classroom 16 h)

Element	Standard
Competency criteria	Batches built to the rules and to the best outcome; offers follow the pricing guide and outcome data; packet answers the QPA and the additional factors (acuity, complexity, good-faith negotiation); entity objections raised on time; disputes complete and correct on the first pass; zero missed deadlines
Supervised production	20 batched disputes, covering at least 160 codes
Assessment	Full packet and written offer rationale for one dispute; reviewed by 2 L4 Senior Specialists II or Badge Panel assessors
QA to earn	97% or higher, and 98% or higher first-pass accuracy
QA to keep	96% or higher and 97% or higher first-pass accuracy, reviewed monthly
Critical errors	Missed selection, offer or packet deadline; dispute prepared so that it is submitted wrong on the Gateway; offer outside the pricing guide without approval

A3. Medical Terminology

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Anatomy, ER clinical terms and abbreviations, reading complex charts in support of coding, appeals and medical-necessity reports
Prerequisite	C5 (classroom 12 h)
Competency criteria	Reads ER clinical terms and abbreviations correctly; abstracts presenting complaint, acuity, workup, treatment and disposition from a complex chart; flags missing or conflicting documentation; explains clinical points in plain words for appeals and reports

Element	Standard
Supervised production	30 chart abstractions reviewed
Assessment	Written test (90% or higher) plus 5 chart abstractions
QA to earn	95% or higher
QA to keep	93% or higher each quarter
Critical errors	Clinical fact misread so that a code, appeal or report is unsupported; abstraction on the wrong patient

A4. Billing Strategy

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Payer billing rules, claim-form and timely-filing strategy, edits and denial prevention, the billing rule library, upstream fixes
Prerequisite	C2 and C3 (classroom 12 h)
Competency criteria	Billing rule library kept current for assigned payers; every rule backed by a payer source or denial data; denial trends reviewed monthly with a root cause; each fix measured by a drop in the denial rate
Supervised production	30 complex claims plus 2 billing fixes reviewed
Assessment	Denial-prevention plan for one payer, presented to the Badge Panel
QA to earn	90% or higher on the panel's scorecard
QA to keep	90% or higher on the quarterly scorecard review
Critical errors	Billing rule published without a source and causing denials; missed timely-filing deadline on a complex claim

A5. Innovation

Element	Standard
Unlocks	Improvement projects: ClickUp automations, AI prompts, IDR Prep Studio improvements, process redesign, with measured results
Prerequisite	L2 (classroom 10 h)
Competency criteria	Each project starts with a baseline and a target; changes tested and approved before release; result measured (for example hours saved or errors avoided); documentation and handover written
Supervised production	One improvement project over a quarter with a measured result
Assessment	Project review by the Badge Panel with the Automation portfolio owner
QA to earn	90% or higher on the panel's scorecard
QA to keep	90% or higher on the quarterly scorecard review
Critical errors	Change released to live work without testing or approval; PHI sent to an unapproved tool

Keeping, suspending and covering badges

A badge is kept only while its QA holds: one review below the bar triggers coaching, and two in a row suspend it. Every June 30 and December 31, a semiannual KPI review decides which badges each member keeps. Consequences start with the December 2027 review.

Situation	What happens	Who decides
One review below the keep threshold	Written coaching plan; 100% review of that badge's work for 30 days	TL

Situation	What happens	Who decides
Two consecutive reviews below the threshold	Badge suspended; that work routes to other holders in the team; re-earn it in the next test window, after half the original supervised case count	Academy chair, with the team manager informed
Any critical error	Case reviewed within 2 business days; a second critical error within 90 days counts as a failed review	TL, escalated to manager
Semiannual review (June 30 and December 31)	A badge is lost if, over the half-year, its QA is below the keep threshold, it has 2 or more critical errors, or it was suspended and not re-earned	Academy Committee
25% or more of badges lost in a half-year	90-day probation and coaching: written plan, 100% review of the affected work, weekly check-ins, re-test in the next window	Team manager and Academy chair
50% or more of badges lost in a half-year	Termination through the HR process, with one appeal (subject to HR and legal review)	Director, on the committee's recommendation
Badge needed for the current level is lost	Level reset at the next quarterly window; pay protected	Team manager and Academy chair
Badge unused for 6 months	Refresher module and 10 supervised cases before routing resumes	Academy chair

Badge loss is counted against the badges held at the start of the half-year, rounded up to whole badges:

Level	Badges held	Probation (25%) at	Termination (50%) at
L1	5	2 lost	3 lost
L2	8	2 lost	4 lost
L3	11	3 lost	6 lost
L4	13	4 lost	7 lost
L5	14	4 lost	7 lost

Team coverage rule: every team keeps at least 2 holders of every B and A badge. The Academy owner publishes a team badge grid monthly; a gap of more than 30 days goes on the manager's scorecard and sets that team's training priorities.

Transition period, January–March 2027

Current staff start at the default level for their role: Seniors at L3, and Negotiators, Coders and Billers at L2. Team leads and managers keep their posts at L5. Each role is ranked on 2026 KPIs, and levels take effect on April 1, 2027. The full rules are in the Badges, Levels and Transition appendix.

Group (per role)	What happens	Result
Top 10%	Earn their role badges automatically, with no tests	Default level confirmed
Middle 80%	Optional skill assessment in January; 3 months to pass their role badge tests (February or March window)	Pass: confirmed. Fail: one level down. Pass the next level's test: one level up
Bottom 10%	Enrolled in the Academy and placed at L1	Return to L2 automatically once they hold the L2 badges

Role badges are earned automatically by the top 10% of each role and tested within 3 months by the middle 80%:

- Negotiator: C2, C5, B2, B5, A2

- Coder: C1, C5, B1, A3
- Biller: C1, C2, C3, C4, B5; plus B3 for those doing MVA or workers' comp
- Senior: the role badges of their specialty

Missing badges for the confirmed level are earned through cross-training by December 31, 2027. The level is held provisionally until then. Current team leads and managers keep their posts and have until December 31, 2027 to complete the L5 badge set, with Academy support. New L5 appointments need the full set and the leveling test.

No one's pay goes down, and every move up a level gets the guaranteed raise from April 1, 2027.

Salary bands by level

Base pay follows level, not individual badges: badges move a person up a level, and the level sets the band. Paying per badge would reward collecting badges the team doesn't need.

Bands are in **USD per month**, built from current pay: new recruits at \$1,000–1,100 and experienced staff at \$1,300–1,800. Team leads stay at **\$1,400–2,000** and managers at **\$2,000–3,000**.

Level	Band min (USD/month)	Midpoint	Band max	Midpoint gap to level below	Where current staff sit
L0 Junior RCM Specialist	1,000	1,050	1,100	—	New recruits (\$1,000–1,100) until they hold the 5 C badges
L1 RCM Specialist I	1,000	1,150	1,300	+10%	Recruits who hold the 5 C badges, and staff placed at L1
L2 RCM Specialist II	1,200	1,375	1,550	+20%	Lower part of today's experienced range
L3 Senior Specialist I	1,400	1,600	1,800	+16%	Upper part of today's experienced range
L4 Senior Specialist II	1,600	1,800	2,000	+13%	New level
L5 Team Lead	1,400	1,700	2,000	—	Matches today's team lead range
L5 Manager	2,000	2,500	3,000	+47% over Team Lead	Set as requested

Level	Band min (USD/month)	Midpoint	Band max	Midpoint gap to level below	Where current staff sit
L5 Senior Manager	To be set	—	—	—	New role

- Overlapping bands let a strong L2 earn more than a new L3, so experience inside a level is still rewarded.
- L4 and Team Lead share the \$2,000 ceiling, so a strong specialist can reach team lead pay without managing people.
- No raise is needed to fit team leads into their band, because it matches today's range.
- No one's pay goes down in the transition, including anyone moved down a level; see the Badges, Levels and Transition appendix.

Badge allowances and variable pay

C and B badges carry no allowance because they are rewarded through the automatic moves to L1 and L2. Each A badge held pays **\$50 a month**, up to 2 per person (\$100 a month), paid only while the badge is active.

A suspended badge stops its allowance from the next pay cycle; it resumes when the badge is re-earned.

Quarterly bonus: a target percentage of base pay, paid on these weights. Any missed deadline caused by the person's own error caps their bonus at 50% for that quarter.

Level	Target bonus (% of quarterly base)	Own portfolio results	Team results	QA and deadlines	Mentoring and specialty-group work
L0	none	—	—	—	—
L1	5%	40%	20%	40%	—
L2	8%	50%	20%	30%	—
L3	10%	50%	20%	20%	10%
L4	12%	40%	20%	20%	20%
Team Lead	12%	20%	60%	20%	—
Manager	15%	—	70% (team) + 30% (all teams)	—	—

"Own portfolio results" means Net Recovery measured against others in the same tier, plus work units against target.

Compliance guard: coding work is never paid on dollars collected. For B1 holders, the coding part of the bonus uses accuracy and productivity only, so no one gains from coding a higher level than the chart supports.

Promotions

Promotions happen in quarterly windows, are open to anyone who meets the criteria, and are never limited to a vacancy for specialist levels.

1. Automatic moves (L0 → L1, L1 → L2): ClickUp and the Academy chair list everyone who holds the badges for the next level. They move up at the next quarterly window, with no test and no minimum time in level.
2. Leveling tests (L3, L4, L5): members who hold the level's badges sit the leveling test in a quarterly test window. L5 also needs a team lead or manager post.
3. Annual top 10%: every December the top 10% of each level earn the missing badges of their level. An L2 in the top 10% moves up to L3 without the leveling test.
4. Calibration panel: the Academy chair and 2 team managers from outside the person's team confirm each L3, L4 and L5 case.
5. Effective date: the first day of the next month. The new portfolio tier starts the same day.
6. Feedback: anyone eligible but not promoted gets the reasons in writing and a target quarter.

Move	How	Pay increase
L0 → L1	Automatic once the 5 C badges are held	5% or the new band minimum, whichever is higher
L1 → L2	Automatic once the L2 badges are held	10% or the new band minimum, whichever is higher
L2 → L3	L3 leveling test, or the annual top 10%	12% or the new band minimum, whichever is higher
L3 → L4	L4 leveling test	12% or the new band minimum, whichever is higher

Move	How	Pay increase
→ Team Lead (L5)	L5 badges and leveling test with a coaching assessment; posted internally	8% or the band minimum, whichever is higher
→ Manager (L5)	L5 badges and leveling test with a leadership assessment; posted internally	15% or the band minimum, whichever is higher

Leadership seats (about 7 manager and 14 TL seats over the expansion) are filled by internal posting first. Applicants need the L5 badge set and a pass in the L5 leveling test.

Pay protection:

- No one's base pay goes down in the transition or when a level is reset.
- Anyone above their band maximum keeps their pay. Their base is frozen, and merit increases are paid as a one-time lump sum until the band catches up or they are promoted.
- Anyone below their band minimum after placement is raised to the minimum within 2 quarters.
- Every move up a level comes with a guaranteed raise.

Tenure rewards

Tenure is rewarded through merit growth inside the band and through benefits, not by moving people up a level. Level stays tied to skill, so long service never outranks proven competency.

Annual merit increase: set by performance rating and position in band, so people low in their band catch up faster. The figures below assume a 5% merit budget; scale them to the actual budget.

Rating	Below midpoint	Near midpoint	Above midpoint
Exceeds	8%	6%	4%
Meets	5%	4%	3%
Below	0%	0%	0%

Benefits by years of service:

Years of service	Added benefit
1	Company pays one external course per year
2	+1 annual leave day
3	+2 annual leave days (total); retention bonus of 5% of annual base; first pick of shift or flexible-hours slots
5	+3 annual leave days (total); retention bonus of 8% of annual base; service award
10	+5 annual leave days (total); retention bonus of 10% of annual base; service award

Transition retention bonus: for staff whose skills are critical through the Jan 1 gateway cutover and the team launch (mainly experienced negotiators and the strongest coders and billers). Pay 10% of annual base, half in July 2027 and half in January 2028, conditional on still being employed and keeping a QA of 95% or higher.

Bridge night rota

Any L2, L3 or L4 member holding B2 can opt in to the bridge night rota. It is no longer limited to 2 team leads.

- **Hours:** 16:00–24:00 Beirut, Monday to Friday (08:00–16:00 US Central).
- **Staffing:** 2 members a night, at least one holding A2 as night lead. The rota reports to the Onshore–Offshore Liaison owner.
- **Duties:** check the tickets due that day, answer the US desk within 15 minutes, fix rejected tickets the same US day, and post the handover log.
- **Rota size:** 10 members at 1 night a week, or 20 members at 1 night every other week, or any size in between, set each quarter from the opt-ins.

Members on the rota	Bonus per member per quarter
10	\$3,000
15	\$2,000

Members on the rota	Bonus per member per quarter
20	\$1,500
30	\$1,000
50	\$600
100	\$300

The bonus comes from a fixed \$30,000 quarterly pool shared equally, within \$300–3,000 per member. It is paid in full when the rota meets its targets (98% first-pass tickets, answers within 15 minutes, no deadline missed because of a ticket) and the member works all assigned nights. Missed nights reduce the share pro rata. Transport home is covered.

Glossary

Codes and abbreviations used in this document.

Code	Stands for
C1–C5	Core badges: the five routine skills every specialist holds by L1 (C = core)
B1–B5	Specialist badges: B1 or B2 plus 2 of B3, B4, B5 for L2; all five for L3 (B = specialist)
A1–A5	Advanced badges: expert skills; at least 1 for L3, 3 for L4 and 4 for L5 (A = advanced)
L0–L4	Specialist levels: Junior RCM Specialist, RCM Specialist I and II, Senior Specialist I and II; L5 Principal is the leadership level
Leveling test	Case-based exam plus a 6-month QA and deadline review, needed for L3, L4 and L5
TL	Team Lead
OON	Out of network
NSA	No Surprises Act, the federal law that covers out-of-network emergency claims

Code	Stands for
NNSA	Non-NSA claims: claims that don't go through the No Surprises Act process
IDR	Independent Dispute Resolution, the federal process for NSA payment disputes
IDRE	IDR entity: the independent arbitrator that decides a dispute
OMB form	The notice that starts the 30-business-day negotiation required before IDR (part of B2)
QPA	Qualifying payment amount: the payer's median in-network rate
MVA	Motor vehicle accident claims
WComp	Workers' compensation claims
PIP / MedPay	Medical coverage inside an auto insurance policy
DOS	Date of service
ERA	Electronic remittance advice: the payer's electronic payment explanation
QA	Quality assurance; also the QA department
PHI	Protected health information
Net Recovery	$(\text{Collected} - \text{initial payment} - \text{IDR fees not refunded}) \div (\text{billed} - \text{initial payment})$